

111.5 "AS SOON AS"

"As soon as" has a similar meaning to "when," but it implies that the second event will take place immediately once the first event is complete.



NOW

I'll call you as soon as I leave work.

[I'll call you immediately when I leave work.]

! COMMON MISTAKES TENSES AFTER TIME CONJUNCTIONS

Future forms are not used after "when" and "as soon as," even if the clause is referring to the future.

The present simple describes the first event, even though it is a future event.

When it gets dark, he'll light the fire. ✓

When it will get dark, he'll light the fire. ✗

Even though this refers to the future, it is incorrect to use a future form.

111.6 "WHILE"

"While" is used to connect two clauses that are happening at the same time.



I watered the plants while my husband mowed the lawn.

FURTHER EXAMPLES



I chopped the vegetables while Ted washed the potatoes.



I didn't get any sleep while the owl was hooting outside.



I read the newspaper while I waited for the kettle to boil.